



North Coast Salmon Update #4 – 21 July 2026

Please note that catch numbers and estimates are preliminary and are subject to review.

The 2026/27 Northern Salmon IFMP is available here: [Northern IFMP](#)

North Coast Troll

Coho and Pink Salmon

The Area F troll, A-B Line (North Dixon Entrance), Pink Salmon directed opening ([FN0589](#)) started on July 1st with retention of Coho and Sockeye salmon permitted. Northern Sockeye bycatch provisions are in effect, allowing retention of Sockeye east of 133 degrees W longitude. There are currently 21 vessels hailed into this opening and total effort to July 18th is estimated to be 200 vessel-days. Weekly estimates of effort, catch and releases are summarized in the following table.

Table 1. Area F Troll – 2026 Estimated weekly catch and release by species

WEEK	End		Chinook		Coho		Pink		Sockeye		Chum	
	Date	Effort	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.
27	4-Jul	19	0	68	1343	0	250	0	1	0	0	10
28	11-Jul	59	0	361	5245	0	1644	0	9	0	0	42
29	18-Jul	122	0	587	6930	13	4087	5	24	0	0	53
Total		200	0	1,016	13,518	13	5,981	5	35	0	0	106

Note: Effort reported as vessel-days.

Chinook Salmon

The Area F Chinook Salmon ITQ and Haida Community Based Fishery (CBF) openings are scheduled to start on August 10th with open areas that include portions of PFMAs 1, 101, 2W and 142. Approximately 90 vessels are expected to participate in the full fleet Chinook opening, which closes on September 30. Retention of Coho and Pink salmon will be permitted in this opening and dockside validation of all Chinook landings is mandatory.

Based on the preseason abundance index of 1.36, the total NBC AABM Chinook TAC for 2026 was set at 164,600 and the preliminary recreational catch forecast is estimated at 35,100 leaving a preliminary Area F TAC of 129,500. This TAC equates to an individual transferrable quota of 762 based on 170 licences remaining.

The Haida CBF opening also includes dual fishing for FSC with mandatory validation of all landings. Area F Chinook and Coho catches are also sampled for CWT recovery and DNA is collected from Chinook and Coho for GSI analysis.

Areas 1 & 2 - Haida Gwaii

Recreational:



Area 1 and 2 recreational catch estimates for June were derived from two data sources, including logbook catch reports from 4 of the 5 five participating fly-in lodges as well as independent estimates of catch and releases generated by the Haida Fisheries creel program, which included 1173 point-of-access interviews recorded at 8 sites. Interview data are used to generate CPUE and fishery activity patterns. Effort estimates are derived from both roving vessel counts and point of access video. Preliminary recreational catch estimates for June are shown in the following table:

Table 2. Preliminary Recreational Catch Estimates, Haida Gwaii

2026 Preliminary estimates of June recreational fishing catch for Haida Gwaii (Areas 1 and 2)

Area	Effort (Boat trips)	Coho	Coho-Rel	Chinook	Chinook-Rel	Pink	Sockeye	Chum	Halibut	Lingcod	Rockfish
1	3,685	2,224	246	4,233	8,292	35	7	271	2,168	2,218	1,214
2E	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2W	589	68	0	1,046	1,515	0	0	7	464	1,456	630
June Total	4,274	2,292	246	5,279	9,807	35	7	278	2,632	3,674	1,844

Note: Catch estimates are preliminary and subject to revision.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-AABM Recreational Fisheries

Areas 1, 2, 142, and that portion of Area 101 west of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- May 29, 2026 to July 31, 2026 - one (1) Chinook per day.
- August 1, 2026 to March 31, 2027 - two (2) Chinook per day.

Area 3 - Nass River

The Nass River Gitwinksihlkw fish wheels have been operating since June 1. In-season run size estimates past the fishwheels are shown in Table 3. The current in-season Sockeye Total Return to Canada (TRTC) forecast is 421,000k, compared to the 1994-2025 mean of 603,000. The current in-season Chinook TRTC forecast is 17,000, compared to the 1994-2025 mean of 30,000.

Table 3. Nass fishwheel in-season run size estimate to July 19, 2026, and historical average cumulative catch (1994-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	192,732	9,248	238	369
1994-2025 Avg.	153,400	17,470	200	160

Data provided by Nisga'a Fisheries and Wildlife Department.

Nass River salmon stock assessment updates from the Nisga'a Fish and Wildlife Department are available by Dropbox [here](#).



Net Fisheries:

Area C:

The Area 3 gill net fishery has been announced to open July 22 & 23, 2026 with retention of sockeye and pink salmon, and non-retention coho, chum, chinook and steelhead.

Area 3 preliminary gill net catches to-date for 2026:



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces) for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 14-Jul-2026

Management Area 3

[Report Details by Subarea or Portion](#)

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		06-Jul	81	4687	0	0	31	58	0	3059	40	0	41	0	0	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
		07-Jul	81	4212	0	0	35	136	9	2124	63	0	66	0	1	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
Total for Week			162	8899	0	0	66	194	9	5183	103	0	107	0	1		
Total for Management Area 3 in Period			162	8899	0	0	66	194	9	5183	103	0	107	0	1		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 14, 2026 at 15:17

Area A:

Preliminary catch data for Area 3 seine up to July 14 is detailed below. Due to poor pink catches and escapement to date, no opportunities will be announced for next week. DFO will continue to monitor pink salmon escapements for further opportunities.



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON SEINE In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 21-Jul-2026**Management Area 3**

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		07-Jul	20	219	0	0	79	78	10	4874	0	0	169	0	0	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
		08-Jul	20	1930	0	0	370	293	0	17442	0	0	161	0	2	Preliminary	09-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	40	2149	0	0	449	371	10	22316	0	0	330	0	2		
		13-Jul	20	1128	0	0	30	2536	0	13834	0	0	24	0	0	Preliminary	15-Jul-2026
		14-Jul	20	1203	0	0	43	2418	0	12108	0	0	15	0	0	Preliminary	15-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	40	2331	0	0	73	4954	0	25942	0	0	39	0	0		
		Total for Management Area 3 in Period	80	4480	0	0	522	5325	10	48258	0	0	369	0	2		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 21, 2026 at 14:58

CSAF Demonstration and Excess to Salmon Spawning Requirements (ESSR) Fisheries:

Two CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Nass Sockeye have been included in the 2026 IFMP. The fishery proponents, the Nisga'a Lisims Government and Gitanyow First Nation, have a combined access to 22.75% of the Canadian Commercial Total Allowable Catch for the Nass. The Gitanyow fishery is expected to be implemented in the coming week and catch information will be available in the next update.

Two CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Area 3 Pink salmon were also included in the 2026 IFMP. North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society (NCSFNSS), Lax Kw'alaams Band and Metlakatla First Nation have indicated an interest in implementing these fisheries to access 18.63% of harvestable surplus for Area 3 Pink salmon, based on the Area 3 commercial seine harvest. To date these fisheries have not been implemented.

As occurred in 2023 and 2024, ESSR fishing plans that target the harvestable surplus of Meziadin Sockeye are undergoing evaluation for potential implementation in 2026.

Recreational Fisheries:*Non-Tidal*

Recreational fishing for Chinook is closed in the Nass River watershed.



North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.
- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye opened in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

Meziadin Fishway:

Fishway operations commenced July 1 for the 2026 season. As of July 20, a total of 60,757 Sockeye have been counted through, compared to the mean 1994-2025 cumulative count to date of 37,683 (Table 4). Water levels were 1.33m (compared to mean 1998-2025 level of 1.29m), and the water temperature was 16.0°C (15.9°C mean 1999-2025).

Table 4. Cumulative Meziadin fishway counts by species to July 20, 2026, compared to historical mean cumulative adult counts to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	60,757	10	0	0
1994-2025 Avg.	37,683	39	0	0

Historic and 2026 counts are available through:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/meziadin-eng.html>

Kwinageese Weir:

The Kwinageese Weir was installed and operational as of July 19. To date, 15 Chinook have passed the weir.

Alaska Fisheries

District 101 Gillnet Fishery:

The District 101 (D1) gillnet fishery opened for four days in US SW 29. Catch and effort information is available below (Table 5).



Table 5. Alaska District 101 gillnet harvest and effort (CPUE) for stat week 29 in 2026 and the 10-year average.

Species	District 1 Catch – Week 29 (CPUE)	10-Year Average (CPUE)
Chinook	80 (1)	118 (1)
Sockeye	3,000 (21)	2,150 (14)
Coho	500 (4)	915 (6)
Pink	3,000 (21)	23,223 (153)
Chum	25,000 (179)	33,765 (222)
Effort (boats)	28	40
Fishing Days	4	4

District 104 Seine Fishery:

The District 104 (D4) purse seine fishery opened on Sunday July 12 and Thursday July 16 for 15 hours each day. Catch and effort information is available below (Table 6).

Table 6. Alaska District 104 seine harvest and effort for start week 29 in 2026.

	Chinook	Sockeye	Coho	Pink	Chum	Boats	Hours
July 12, 2026	-	1,200	500	1,300	4,200	9	15
July 16, 2026	-	200	100	600	1,600	5	15

More information on Southeast Alaskan fisheries is available here:

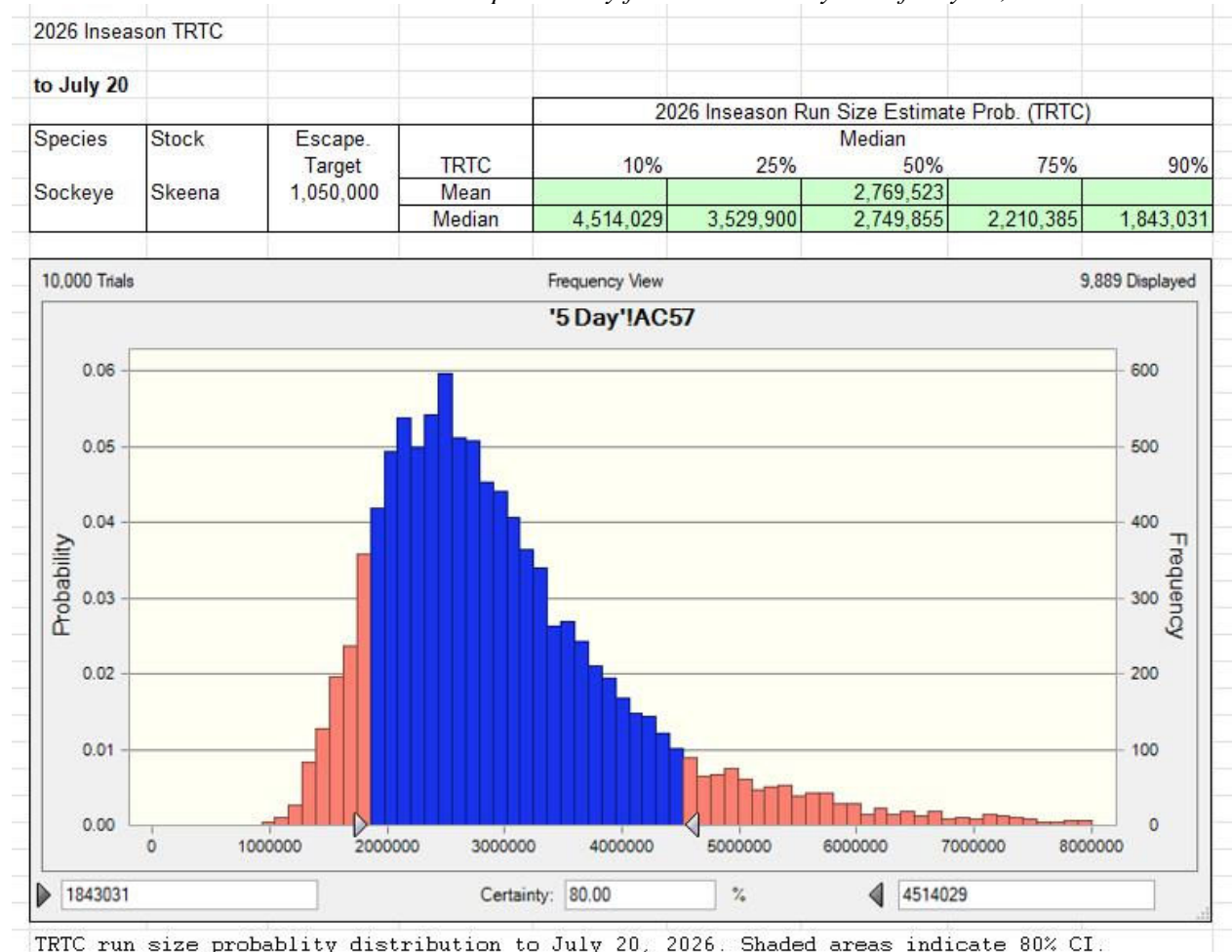
<http://www.adfg.alaska.gov/index.cfm?adfg=fishing.main>

Area 4 - Skeena River

Based on results from the Tyee test fishery to July 20, the current run size estimates for Skeena sockeye range from 1.84M-4.51M (80% certainty), with a mean (point) estimate of 2.769 M (Table 7, Figure 1). The in-season TRTC estimate has continued to trend downwards and is being monitored carefully to inform fisheries decisions.



Table 7. 2026 in-season run size estimate probability for Skeena Sockeye as of July 13, 2026.



TRTC run size probability distribution to July 20, 2026. Shaded areas indicate 80% CI.

Figure 1. Total return to Canada run size probability distribution to July 20 2026. Shaded areas indicate 80% CI.

Tyee Test Fishery:

The test fishery began operation on June 10, 2026. As of July 20, the estimated number of large Sockeye past Tyee is 917,080. Using average run timing (1985-2025), it is estimated that 37.5% of the run has passed Tyee as of this date.

Table 8. Tyee test fishery cumulative index to date July 20, 2026 and ten-year average (2016-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Coho	Pink (even)	Chum	Lg. Chinook	Steelhead
2026	614.29	2.19	6.74	3.76	90.13	22.72
2025	473.42	1.26	-	1.64	100.74	6.19
2024	519.08	1.36	39.37	1.69	48.05	30.42
2023	627.99	1.82	-	0.21	77.5	1.68



2022	862.63	2.84	3.56	1.14	130.38	5.31
2016-2025 Average	397.84	1.64	15.70	1.12	73.66	15.59

The 2026 Tyee test fishery daily and cumulative Sockeye escapement estimate data, along with 2026 daily and cumulative escapement indices by species, are available here:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/skeenatyee-eng.html>

Net Fisheries:

Area C:

There have been 9 gill net openings in Area 4 so far this season. Preliminary catches in Area 4 up to July 19 are listed below. Catch data for July 20 and 21 will be provided in the next update. Further fishing opportunities for gillnets have been announced for July 23, 24 & 25.

Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 21-Jul-2026

Management Area 4

				Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		10-Jul	114	11463	0	0	71	0	34	0	27	0	133	0	16	Preliminary	13-Jul-2026
		11-Jul	116	11635	0	0	92	0	44	0	14	0	32	0	8	Preliminary	13-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	230	23098	0	0	163	0	78	0	41	0	165	0	24		
		13-Jul	116	17116	0	0	34	173	0	0	95	0	72	0	20	Preliminary	15-Jul-2026
		14-Jul	116	13994	0	0	65	106	0	0	63	0	32	0	16	Preliminary	15-Jul-2026
		16-Jul	148	22301	0	0	17	881	0	0	143	0	130	0	49	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		17-Jul	139	22519	0	0	116	1289	0	0	209	0	22	0	139	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	519	75930	0	0	232	2449	0	0	510	0	256	0	224		
		19-Jul	140	26346	0	0	128	1753	0	0	166	0	91	0	141	Preliminary	21-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	140	26346	0	0	128	1753	0	0	166	0	91	0	141		
		Total for Management Area 4 in Period	889	125374	0	0	523	4202	78	0	717	0	512	0	389		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 21, 2026 at 14:41

Area A:

Catch estimates from the Area 4 seine ITQ fishery for the period July 15 to July 19 are detailed below. Further openings for this fishery in Area 4 have been announced for July 22 to July 26.

Fishery Operations System
Commercial SALMON SEINE In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 21-Jul-2026

Management Area 4				Report Details by Subarea or Portion													
Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		15-Jul	7	1149	0	0	19	236	0	0	49	0	77	0	19	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		16-Jul	14	1955	0	0	53	480	0	0	96	0	120	0	41	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		17-Jul	17	4756	0	0	129	1109	0	0	172	0	112	0	65	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		18-Jul	12	2555	0	0	69	554	0	0	114	0	90	0	41	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	50	10415	0	0	270	2379	0	0	431	0	399	0	166		
		19-Jul	11	2165	0	0	67	451	0	0	127	0	83	0	40	Preliminary	20-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	11	2165	0	0	67	451	0	0	127	0	83	0	40		
		Total for Management Area 4 in Period	61	12580	0	0	337	2830	0	0	558	0	482	0	206		

Notes:
1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 21, 2026 at 15:09

CSAF Demonstration and Excess to Salmon Spawning Requirements (ESSR) Fisheries:

Seven CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Skeena Sockeye were included in the 2026 Northern BC Salmon IFMP. North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society (NCSFNSS), Kitsumkalum Band, Kitselas First Nation, Metlakatla First Nation, Lax Kw'alaams Band, Gitxsan First Nation, and Lake Babine Nation fisheries represent access to 22.75% of the Canadian Commercial Allowable Catch, further divided by geographic access and proponent.

Area 4 marine Demonstration fisheries were implemented July 15, 18, and 19 and catch information to date is included below (Table 9). Please note catches have been combined to meet privacy requirements. Additional openings will be communicated by fisheries notice.

Table 9. Area 4 CSAF demonstration fishery catches and effort to date.

Date	Area	Effort (# of boats)	sockeye retained	pink retained
8-Jul	4-12 & 4-15	3	129	0
9-Jul	4-9 & 4-12	12	2,227	0
12-Jul	4-12	7	1,326	0
12-Jul	4-5, 4-9, 4-15	6	1,853	0
15-Jul	4-12 & 4-5	5	937	0
15-Jul	4-15	4	649	0
18-Jul	4-12	9	1,426	0
18-Jul/19-Jul	4-15, 4-12, 4-5	5	1,535	0
Total		51	5,535	0

In-river Skeena sockeye directed demonstration fisheries began in the lower river at the end of last week and catches from those fisheries will be included in the next update.



Two ESSRs in the Skeena River watershed were included in the 2026 Northern BC Salmon IFMP: Babine Sockeye (Lake Babine Nation) and Bulkley River Pink salmon (Office of the Wet'suwet'en). Openings for these fisheries will be announced via fisheries notice.

Recreational Fisheries:

Area 3 and 4 Creel Survey

June Summary

The North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society began their creel survey operations in May of 2026. In June of 2026 they performed 436 interviews totalling 1,384 anglers with a reported catch of 489 Chinook and 178 Coho. These numbers are expanded to produce a catch (kept) estimate of 2,757 Chinook and 1,014 Coho.

Non-Tidal

Recreational fishing for Chinook started closed for the 2026 season in the Skeena River watershed and all rivers and lakes flowing into PFMA's 3 to 6, excluding the Kitimat River.

Recreational fishing for Sockeye opened on the Skeena River mainstem on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of two (2).

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.
- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

**Kitwanga Weir:**

The Gitanyow Fisheries Authority will be operating the Kitwanga Weir. It is typically operational by early July. Updates provided by the Gitanyow Fisheries Authority will be available here: www.gitanyowfisheries.com

Sustut Weir:

The Sustut Weir is expected to be operational by August 1 by the Province of BC.

Kispiox River:

Water conditions in the Kispiox River, reflective of Drought Management considerations, will be communicated throughout the season.

Area 6**Net Fisheries:***Area A*

Area 6 inspections to date suggest poor pink escapement. No opportunities are anticipated at this time. DFO will continue to monitor for future opportunities.

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CSAF Demonstration Fisheries

One CSAF demonstration fishery targeting Area 6 Pink salmon was included in the 2026 Northern BC Salmon IFMP. It is not expected that this fishery will proceed this season.

Areas 7 to 10 - Central Coast**Net Fisheries:**

There have been five, 24-hour Chinook-directed commercial gill net fisheries in Area 8 to date this season, held on June 1, 8, 15, 22 and 29. Preliminary catch estimates for the Area C gill net fishery are provided below.

The Nuxalk demonstration fishery was opened for 24 hours on July 2, 2026; preliminary catch information is forthcoming. There are no further Chinook-directed commercial gill net openings planned.



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Area C (Central) and
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 06-Jul-2026

Management Area 8

[Report Details by Subarea or Portion](#)

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		01-Jun	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	Preliminary	03-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0		
		08-Jun	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0	Preliminary	11-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0		
		15-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0	Preliminary	18-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0		
		22-Jun	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0	Preliminary	25-Jun-2026
		Total for Week	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0		
		29-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0	Preliminary	02-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0		
		Total for Management Area 8 in Period	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	873	228	0	0	0		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

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Central Coast Recreational Fisheries:

Data will be provided when available later in the season.

As per FN0687; Effective July 10, 2026 at 00:01 hours until 23:59 hours on August 17, 2026. The daily limit for Chinook is zero (0) per day in the tidal waters of Subareas 9-3 to 9-9.

The Heiltsuk, Kitasoo Xai'xais, Nuxalk, and Wuikinuxv Nations, with the coordination of the Central Coast Indigenous Resource Alliance (CCIRA) continue to collect data through a creel survey and DNA sampling program. The program will assess recreational and First Nations' Food, Social, and Ceremonial (FSC) fisheries in marine portions of Areas 6 to 9. Survey work will occur through September 2026. Recreational and Indigenous fishers should be aware that they may be approached by creel surveyors from the Nations to collect important data from these fisheries.